Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: Jan 28, 2026 - 6:30 to 8:00 - library

Hybrid Meeting - https://meet.google.com/chx-bcyt-pvr

School Council Meeting

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools. They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** Present: In Person: A Chong, S McCracken, H Train, K Davy, L Paetkau, C Rainville, T Goudy Online: R Sahota Regrets: J Stere, A Schofield, L Tam	1 mins	Co-Chair
2	**Territorial Acknowledgement & Equity Connection** - In Staff meeting Jason discussed that mother earth was very snowy, landslides, big storms and earthquakes and reflection surrounding the earth and what can we do to take care of her and honour her for future generations	2 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
3	**Council Housekeeping** - Approval of Nov School Council Minutes - heather - motion for approval - second caroline - 6 - Approved	5 mins	Co-Chair (L.Tam)
4	**News** ***Community Partnership*** – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - **Update** www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com - For more information, please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com - March break camp sign up is already open - Summer camp sign up on March 19th Summer camp list compiled and will be distributed on School Day	5 mins	SNA Representative

WRAPC/PIC https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/ - WRAPSC Minutes	5 mins	WRAPSC Rep (vacant)

7:00 PM - Special Guest - Barry Kingsley Senior Manager of Facility Services - Been at school board for many decades (35 years), we have never had worse service - Last year snowplow bid went out to tender, not placing blame, just giving facts and the reality of the situation - Received bidders, learning new procurement rules, broader public sector, new procurement department that is very thorough and in this process take bidders that were submitted, did due diligence, examined references, questioned companies, reviewed their workload (cannot ask for all contracts they take on), believe that all due diligence was performed and a fairly robust tendered doc, but not getting the level of service they were promised and what they expected. what WDRSB has provided in the past, company is now quick to respond when called, but the issue is that they shouldn't need to be called to do their job. - 5 managers and 12 supervisors on Barry's team, we have fielded 7-10,000 calls, emails, texts, voicemails from parent councils, trustees, principals, they have been grilled as everyone is upset with the level of service, - had meeting 3.5 weeks ago with contractor, and have since seen a noticeable improvement overall - came to see on Monday snowday and sent message about sidewalk and this got fixed - confident that level of service that will be provided for the remainder of the year will be better - they will not be making the same mistakes for next year - Some maps were mildly incorrect (small missing pathway or bus drop off not marked) - Brantco had the contract for years so knew what they were doing with each of the maps - Timing of snowfall can make things extremely difficult (when it falls between 3-5 am) to clear them by 7am before schools starting - Met with contractor again today, some improvements have been seen but cautiously optimistic and weather is not going to be good over the coming months - Will be meeting every 2 weeks with them - Student safety is their #1 concern, and public safety as well - Can reach out to him personally if we feel things aren't being handled - Support in any way they possibly can - Contractor has hired new quality control supervisor - Don't want to go down to the asphalt right now due to the salt shortage, sand is available but doesn't help as much - Salt depots are empty this is an Ontario wide problem	15 mins	Principal (J. Stere)

Teacher Update - Funds provided for the students by school council for Kindness bracelets, neurodiverse materials that were appropriate for everyone to enjoy, very positive feedback from this event in December - Busing provided by School Council to visit the Toyota Manufacturing plant, grade 3s went on this field trip and had a fantastic time	10 mins	Teacher Rep (A. Schofield)

	- Grade 8s have opportunity to purchase spirit wear, support given by council to buy a hoodie for equity fund for those that would like - Basketball is happening right now - Many clubs on the go, Librarian has agreed to supervise a lot of these ie. reading club, science, Minecraft, band, D&D, and games club these are student led initiatives, need to propose their club and get it reviewed and approved - Teachers can sign up for the band to go to their classroom and play for them		
5	**Principal's Report** - Report card season is underway, staffing starts in about a month - Kindergarten registration is open and we already have 50 for next school year, this is many more than what we usually have at this time in other years - Bolards - who is funding them? is painting a part of the plan?	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)
6	**New Agenda Items** - **Revisit & New Requests** - 25/26 Requests for School Council Funds - Pete Moss concert approved - Wireless microphones approved - North American Forest animals for K2 (paint pucks and jumbo crayons school expense as they are for curriculum) $75 approved	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)
7	**Financial Report** - Treasurer Report - See Below	10 min	Treasurer (S. McCracken)
8	**Subcommittees** **1) Pizza Subcommittee - Chair - K. Davy** ○ Members: ▪ Chair - Kate Davy ▪ Secretary - Heather Train ▪ Volunteer Coordinator - Shaun McCracken ▪ Pizza Procurement Specialist - Darpana Sanghvi Pizza council representatives have the autonomy to acknowledge pizza issues and make decisions accordingly. **Email from Admin - Feb 2 2026** School Council Members, We hope you all had a good weekend. We wanted to clarify some of the discussion items that were raised as concerns at our past School Council meeting. The service and funding that the pizza committee offers is so valuable to our school community. We look forward to this continuing in the near future. We recognize that with this hardwork there also comes challenges. Our goal is to support you in those challenges but to also recognize that there are issues beyond the pizza committee's scope and sequence that we must acknowledge. Working together in trust and collaboration, with shared understandings, is key to the success of this valuable service. Below are some key tenets to provide some clarity. ***Refunds***: We must remember that Sarah supports pizza day out of the goodness of her heart. This is not part of her job description. She enjoys helping us but as an admin team we must work to make her job easier at every turn. Nutrition break is very busy for our team.	15 mins	Chair (A. Jones)

- Phone calls to Sarah from parents/caregivers whose children were sick or absent on pizza day, will be dealt with on an individualized basis. This will depend on what Sarah is doing at the time. ***The option of a refund is always an option.*** This dollar figure(refunds) equates to a minimal amount each term(20 to 40$ total)

Siblings picking up pizza:

- If a student comes to the pizza table to pick up their brother/sister's pizza, and ***they are on the pizza list*** as having ordered pizza, pizza volunteer members can give said sibling their brother/sister's pizza. If they are NOT on the list, they should be directed to the main office.

Pizza Volunteer members picking up pizza for fellow School Council members:

- If a pizza volunteer member knows that a fellow member's child is absent, and they want to pick up their pizza, ***and they are on the list***, they are welcomed to do so. School Council members and pizza volunteers are expected to follow the same guidelines as the rest of our school population.

Key points if students are NOT on the ordered list:

- Students who are not on the pizza order list as having ordered pizza but claim they have, are to be directed to the main office for support. There are many nuances to these situations that involve privacy, safety and liability issues with students. Sarah will seek assistance from Tara/Jason with complex cases. Mistakes made by our community, by the ordering software or by the school, fall on the shoulders of Mr. Stere - School Council/Pizza Volunteers are not expected to deal with these.
- ***We do NOT use past history/patterns of ordering*** in our decision making for the present week in question.
- Students in conflict over pizza are to be directed to the main office.

Each week may present new and unique challenges. Tara and Jason will deal with those challenges in the main office, in the moment, with each child/family's best interest in mind. Our approaches may differ, but rest assured that we chat daily and we trust one another in their decisions. We use a fairness model - which differs from sameness or equal.

In Elementary School we use a saying, "Keep Small Problems Small and seek help to solve"

Our goal is always to simplify your role as pizza volunteers so you continue to enjoy coming here and interacting with our community. We definitely enjoy having you here.

If you have any questions or concerns, you are welcome to call Jason or Tara and we will be happy to chat with you.

You are appreciated,
Jason and Tara

	Inquire with Dominos for recycling the pizza boxes coming to pick them up at the end of lunch		
9	**Questions & Answer Period**	5 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:** Feb 25, 2026 6:30 to 8:00 in library		In-person & Online
11	**Agenda Items for Next Meeting** The mission of the School Council is to work to ensure the highest academic achievement and personal development of all of our Silverheights students. Please complete google form: Agenda Item Request for School Council	1 min	Chair (A. Jones)
12	Adjournment		

Notes:

MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education

PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)

PRO – Parents Reaching Out

SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)

WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

A	B	C	D	E
Silverheights Public School - Parent Council				
Financial Report Feb 25, 2026				
	Debit	**Credit**	**Total**	**Notes**
Income 2025/26				
Pizza Sales- School day*		$ 67,500.00		*95% of Projected Forecast for Revenue
Domino's fund code*		$ 500.00		*Estimate based on 2024/25 School Year
Total Income:			***$ 68,000.00***	
Approved Expenditures				
Domino's Pizza	-$ 35,000.00			*Estimated Cost for Pizza Days
School Day Fees	-$ 1,350.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Field Trip Fund	-$ 6,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Grade 8 Celebration	-$ 5,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Breaking Barriers Fund (Admin Use) Field Trips, Spirit Wear, Athletic Wear	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
ASD Caregiver Support Event	-$ 500.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Self-Regulation Tools	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Floor Mops & Boot Scrubbers	-$ 985.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Spirit Committee - Kindness Month	-$ 300.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Drama (Grd 5&6) - Wireless Microphones	-$ 250.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
Pete Moss - Nature Education Performance	-$ 550.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
Sound Trap Subscription - Grd 7/8	-$ 1,500.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
K2 Indigenous Learning Activity Supplies	-$ 75.00			Approved in January 2026 Meeting
Teacher Education Account (E-Way)	-$ 4,000.00			Approved in February 2026 Meeting
Cricut Machine Allocation - Library	-$ 500.00			Approved in February 2026 Meeting
Total Approved Expenditures:			**-$ 58,010.00**	
Pending/Future Meeting Requests				
Grade 8 Door Skins	-$ 3,000.00			Deferred to April 2026 Meeting
			-$ 3,000.00	
Total Projected Available Funds:			**$ 6,990.00**	*Projected estimate*